

THIS REQUEST FOR INFORMATION (RFI) - IS ISSUED SOLELY FOR INFORMATION AND PLANNING PURPOSES ONLY AND DOES NOT CONSTITUTE A SOLICITATION.

THE SUBMISSION OF PRICING, CAPABILITIES FOR PLANNING PURPOSES, AND OTHER MARKET INFORMATION IS HIGHLY ENCOURAGED AND ALLOWED UNDER THIS RFI IN ACCORDANCE WITH (IAW) FAR 15.201(e).

SEE ATTACHMENT FOR DETAILS:

“PATHOLOGY BONE SAW SYSTEM FOR WASHINGTON DC VAMC”

“BRAND NAME OR EQUAL TO EXAKT ” – SEE DETAILS IN THE SOW.

*** OEM DISTRIBUTOR/AUTHORIZATION LETTER FROM THE MANUFACTURER IS REQUIRED FOR ALL RESPONSES, IF NO OEM LETTER IS SUPPLIED THE VENDOR WILL BE CONSIDERED NON-RESPONSIVE & THE VENDOR WILL BE DIS-QUALIFIED AT THE TIME RFI WILL CLOSE *.**

*** MUST COMPLETE BUY AMERICAN CERTIFICATE - FAR 52.225-2*.**

*** IF THE VENDOR DON'T PROVIDE THE ANSWERS FOR ALL THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS (1-14). ** THE VENDOR WILL BE CONSIDERED NON-RESPONSIVE & VENDOR WILL BE DISQUALIFIED AT THE TIME RFI WILL CLOSE *.**

This is a requirement for:

U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs VA Medical Center (VAMC).

DESCRIPTION: The Washington DC VA VAMC requires the contractor **to deliver within 90 days** from contract award to the VA medical facility warehouse below during normal business hours from 8:00 a.m. to 3:30 p.m. (EST), Monday through Friday:

Delivery to:

U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs
Washington DC VA Medical Center
WAREHOUSE/ATTN:
50 Irving Street NW
Washington, DC 20422.

DISCLAIMER: This RFI is issued solely for information and planning purposes only and does not constitute a solicitation. All information received in response to this RFI that is marked as proprietary will be handled accordingly. IAW FAR 15.201(e), responses to this notice are not offers and cannot be accepted by the Government to form a binding contract. Responders are solely responsible for all expenses associated with responding to this RFI.

Note: The contractor shall deliver the required commodities (Please see attachments) no later than 90 days or less from the date of the award, otherwise directed by the Contracting Officer (CO). Commodities shall not be delivered to the Government site on Federal holidays or weekends unless directed by the CO. Delivery shall be made between the hours of 8:00 am and 3:30 pm at the delivery location, during normal workday business hours.

The U.S. Government is Performing Market Research to identify responsible sources who have the skills, experience, and knowledge required to successfully meet the requirements. Information received from Market Research will determine the best acquisition strategy and if responsible sources exist for competition, and/or a total Small Business Set-Aside. This is only for Market Research but may result in an invitation to an open discussion with the U.S. Government. This notice is not to be construed as a commitment by the U.S. Government. All information is to be submitted at no cost or obligation to the U.S. Government.

Any information submitted by respondents to this notice is strictly voluntary. Propriety information or trade secrets should be clearly marked. The information received will not be returned. The U.S. Government reserves the right to reject, in whole or in part, any private sector input as a result of this Sources Sought notice/market survey.

The U.S. Government is not obligated to notify respondents of the results of this notice. All responses to this Sources Sought must be submitted to the point of contact listed herein. This does not constitute a commitment, implied or otherwise, that procurement will be accomplished and is not a request for proposal or invitation for bid. Responding to this notice in no manner guarantees a contract will be awarded.

**** MUST ANSWER ALL THE FOLLOWING QUESTIONS (FROM 1 TO 14) TO
QUALIFY FOR THIS SOLICITATION ****

****Respondents to this source sought announcement capable of manufacturing these items should at a minimum provide the following information for U.S. Government review****

1. Please indicate the size status and representations of your business, such as but not limited to: Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business (SDVOSB), Veteran Owned Small Business (VOSB), HUBZone, Woman Owned Small Business (WOSB), Large Business, etc.
2. Is your company considered small under the NAICS code identified under this RFI?
3. Are you the manufacturer or distributor of the items being referenced above?
4. Must provide the Manufacture Name (OEM) & Manufacturer Part (MPN).
5. Must complete the Buy American Certificate. **FAR 52.225-2.**
6. If you are not a manufacturer. The company shall provide an OEM authorized distributor or reseller letter from original equipment manufacturers (OEM) to qualify for this requirement. If no OEM letter will be provided. The vendor will be considered nonresponsive, and the vendor will be disqualified at the time source sought notice (RFI) will close.
7. Does all the items are on FSS/GSA. If the answer is yes. Please provide the FSS/GSA Contract Number and special item number (SIN) & OEM Letter from the Manufacturer that you are authorized to sell this product.
8. Does all the items are on NAC/SAC or SEWP V. Please provide the contract number.
9. Please provide general pricing for your products/solutions for market research purposes.
10. Legal Business/Company Name (as it is indicated in <https://sam.gov>).
11. Unique Entity ID UEI (SAM).
12. Warranty Information (Can be a separate attachment).
13. Point of Contact Name, Telephone number and email address.
14. Must provide the estimated delivery time frame after award. For example: Within 60 days ARO, Within 90 days ARO.

The Government intends to award a Firm-Fixed Price (FFP) contract for this purchase. To be considered for award, prospective quoters must be registered with the System for Award Management (SAM) website and complete representations and certifications at <https://www.sam.gov> . Prospective awardees MUST be registered with the System for Award Management (SAM) at <http://www.sam.gov>. PRIOR TO AWARD and through final payment and must complete the Online Representations and Certifications Application (ORCA) at <http://www.sam.gov> prior to award and through final payment. CONTRACT WILL NOT BE AWARDED UNTIL SAM REGISTRATION HAS BEEN COMPLETED. SDVOSB and VOSB socio-economic categories MUST be verified in the SBA Website, U.S. Small Business Administration: <https://veterans.certify.sba.gov>, at the time of receipt of quotes and at the time of award.

Responses to this notice shall be submitted via email: Mohsin.Abbas2@va.gov. No Telephone responses shall not be accepted. Responses must be received no later than Wednesday, May 20, 2026, by 12:00 PM (EST).

Responses to this Sources Sought notice will be utilized by the Government to make appropriate acquisition decisions. After reviewing the responses to this Sources Sought notice, a solicitation announcement may or may not be published in SAM.GOV/Open Market or GSA eBuy.

STATEMENT OF WORK (SOW)

“BRAND NAME OR EQUAL TO EXAKT”

1. CONTRACT TITLE.

Pathology Bone Saw System

2. BACKGROUND.

The Washington DC VA Medical Center has a requirement to replace the current pathology band saws. The vendor for the current band saws has gone out of business, so there are no parts available for repairs. The end-users are using rubber bands as a supplement for the latex bands needed on the internal wheels, as the latex bands are no longer available. This new model will provide the users with better precision and enhanced safety features.

3. SCOPE OF WORK.

The procurement shall include all parts, materials, labor, software/licenses, resources, and training required to implement and utilize the equipment/system to their fullest capacity. All items must be covered by manufacturer's warranty and procured through a manufacturer-approved distribution channel. Distributors and

resellers must be able to document ability to provide items through manufacturer-approved distribution channels upon request.

4. SPECIFICATIONS.

4.1 Equipment

LINE-ITEM DESCRIPTION	QUANTITY
EXAKT 302 Diamond Band Saw System Complete System. Includes: EXAKT 302 Diamond Band Saw - Cutting Band 0.2 mm/D126 - Cleaning Gun - Laser Cutting Line Indicator - Whetstone - Protective Cover. Discount and Tariff Impact included. Installation (One day on-site startup/operations Training) included. "BRAND NAME OR EQUAL TO EXAKT"	2

4.2 REQUIRED FEATURES:

- Two (2) EXAKT 302 Diamond Band Saw Systems
 - Complete System Includes:
 - - EXAKT 302 Diamond Band Saw
 - - Cutting Band 0.2 mm/D126
 - - Cleaning Gun
 - - Laser Cutting Line Indicator
 - - Whetstone
 - - Protective Cover
- Bone saw designed specifically for pathology lab
- Maximum size (H x W x D): 30" X 24" X 23"
- Maximum weight: 90 lbs
- Band saw grinds to produce samples
- Continuous waterflow over blade
- Capable of automatic shutdown
- Perform freehand cuts down to 1mm
- Automatic band tension adjustment.
- Stainless steel frame

5. SPECIFIC TASKS.

5.1 Delivery.

- i. All equipment shall be delivered to:
Washington DC VA Medical Center
50 Irving St NW
Washington, DC 20422
ATTN: VHAWAS Equipment Committee
- ii. Contract VA Purchase Order (PO) number shall be included with delivery information (e.g., packing slip).

Note: PO number starts with station code 688 followed by a letter and 5 digits (e.g., 688A12345)

- iii. Delivery Hours: The Warehouse is open to receive deliveries Monday through Friday, 8:00 a.m. to 4:00 p.m., excluding holidays.
- iv. Contractor shall coordinate delivery with the on-site Point of Contact (POC) and provide shipment tracking information.
- v. Contractor shall verify delivery date and time with the on-site POC at least 3 business days prior to scheduled delivery.
- vi. Delivery is required within 90 days from award of the contract.

5.2 ON SITE PROCEDURES.

- i. COVID-19 Screening: All persons entering the facility shall be subject to screening for COVID-19 per the current CDC (Center for Disease Control) guidelines.
- ii. Mask Requirement: All contractors shall wear masks while indoors.
- iii. Contract personnel are required to identify themselves as such to avoid creating an impression in the minds of members of the public that they are Government Officials.
- iv. Time spent on site shall be for a period sufficient to complete the work set forth in the statement of work.
- v. On-site visits shall be scheduled in advance with the designated on-site POC.
- vi. Contractors shall check in and out with Biomedical Engineering prior to visiting the worksite for each day of work.
- vii. The VA campus is non-smoking. Contractor personnel are required to comply with this policy.
- viii. Parking: it is the responsibility of the Contractor to park in the appropriate designated parking areas.
- ix. Contractor personnel's tool bags are subject to inspection.

5.3 Installation/Implementation.

- i. Installation/Implementation will be completed by personnel certified and knowledgeable with the designated equipment/system.
- ii. Installation shall be completed within the period of performance.
- iii. Contractors shall be responsible for any Personal Protection Equipment (PPE) required when performing work on site.
- iv. Contractor shall submit all removable media to be used on a VA system to Biomedical Engineering for scanning with anti-virus software prior to use.
- v. In the case of turn-in, exchange, repair, or replacement of equipment containing hard drives used by the VA, the hard drives shall be removed from the equipment and remain in possession of the VA (this includes loaned or rented equipment).
- vi. The contractor shall take all necessary precautions to prevent damage to any government property. The contractor shall report any damage immediately and shall be assessed current replacement costs for property damaged by

the contractor, unless corrective action is taken. Any damaged material (i.e., trees, shrubs, lawn/turf, curbs, gutters, sidewalks, etc.) will be replaced in a timely manner or corrected by the contractor with like materials, at no extra cost to the government, upon approval of the Contracting Officer.

5.4 Training.

- i. Contractor shall be responsible for providing training to clinical staff/users.
- ii. Training is to be scheduled in advance with the designated on-site POC.
- iii. Education shall be provided prior to and/or at time of installation.
- iv. Education professionals shall be certified to provide instruction on the designated equipment/system.
- v. Education curriculum must include operations and set-up, user maintenance, safety, and user troubleshooting tips.

5.5 Inspection and Acceptance.

- i. Contractor shall conduct a joint inspection with the on-site POC upon completion of installation.
- ii. In the event deficiencies are identified, the contractor shall provide the date when the identified deficiencies will be addressed if not addressed on the date of installation. The Contractor shall conduct a joint inspection with the on-site POC after addressing all deficiencies. All deficiencies identified in the joint inspections shall be corrected by the Contractor prior to Government acceptance of the item. Any disputes shall be resolved by the Contracting Officer.

5.6 Deliverables.

The Contractor shall provide the below documentation for the proposed equipment to VHAWASEquipmentRequests@va.gov within 10 business days of work completion:

- i. Service report.
- ii. Warranty information.
- iii. Electronic copy of the Operators Manual.
- iv. Electronic copies of the complete technical service manuals, including troubleshooting guides, necessary diagnostic software and equipment information, schematic diagrams, and parts lists.

6. HOURS OF OPERATION.

DC VAMC's normal business hours are Monday-Friday, 8:00 am to 4:30 pm, excluding observed Federal holidays:

New Year's Day	Labor Day
Martin Luther King's Birthday	Columbus Day
President's Day	Veteran's Day
Memorial Day	Thanksgiving Day
Juneteenth	Christmas Day
Independence Day	Any other national holiday as declared by the President of the United States

7. PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE.

Delivery is expected within 90 days of contract award.

8. INVOICING.

Contractor shall submit a consolidated invoice monthly in arrears of the month for which services are being billed. One all-inclusive monthly invoice shall be provided, which shall contain an invoice number, contract number, obligations order number, and an itemized list of services provided. An acceptable master (all-inclusive) itemized list of services shall be agreed to between the Contractor and the COR prior to submission of the first invoice.

All invoices from the contractor shall be submitted electronically in accordance with VAAR Clause 852.232-72 Electronic Submission of Payment Requests.

VA's Electronic Invoice Presentment and Payment System (IPPS) – The VA Financial Services Center (FSC) uses a third-party contractor, Tungsten, to transition vendors from paper to electronic invoice submission. Please go to this website to begin submitting electronic invoices, free of charge:

<http://www.tungsten-network.com/US/en/veterans-affairs/>.

More information on the VA FSC is available at: <http://www.fsc.va.gov/einvoice.asp>.

Vendor e-Invoice Set-Up Information:

To begin submitting your electronic invoices to the VA FSC for payment processing, free of charge, please contact Tungsten at the phone number below or email address:

Tungsten e-Invoice Setup Information: 1-877-489-6135

Tungsten e-Invoice Email: VA.Registration@Tungsten-Network.com

If you have a question about the e-invoicing program or Tungsten, please contact the FSC at the below phone number email address.

FSC e-Invoice Contact Information: 1-877-353-9791

FSC e-Invoice Email: vafscshd@va.gov

9. CONTRACT TYPE.

Firm-Fixed Priced Contract

10. EVALUATION FACTORS.

- i. Required Features. "Brand name or equal to Exakt".
- ii. OEM Authorization/distributor letter from the manufacturer is required for all responses, if no OEM letter is supplied the vendor will be considered non-responsive and the vendor will be dis-qualified at the time RFI will close.
- iii. Delivery Lead Times
- iv. Completed Buy American Certificate
- v. The Government will evaluate offers in IAW with the policies and procedures of part 25 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).
- vi. Price.

LINE - ITEM DESCRIPTION

PATHOLOGY BONE SAW SYSTEM

“BRAND NAME OR EQUAL TO EXAKT”

B.2 PRICE/COST SCHEDULE

ITEM INFORMATION

ITEM NUMBER	DESCRIPTION OF SUPPLIES/SERVICES	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT PRICE	AMOUNT
0001	EXAKT 302 DIAMOND BAND SAW SYSTEM COMPLETE SYSTEM INCLUDES: EXAKT 302 Diamond Band Saw - Cutting Band 0.2 mm/D126 - Cleaning Gun - Laser Cutting Line Indicator - Whetstone - Protective Cover. Discount and Tariff Impact included. Installation (One day on-site startup/operations Training) included. "BRAND NAME OR EQUAL TO EXAKT" CONTRACT TYPE: FIRM-FIXED PRICE	2.00	EA		
				GRAND TOTAL	